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THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

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MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Trilateral Meeting with President Boris
Yeltsin of Russia on Security Issues (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Warren Christopher, Secretary of State
Thomas Pickering, U.S. Ambassador to Russia
William Miller, U.S. Ambassador to Ukraine
Anthony Lake, Assistant to the President for
National Security Affairs
Strobe Talbott, Deputy Secretary of State
(Designate)
Frank Wisner, Under Secretary of Defense
for Policy
LTG Michael Ryan, Assistant to the Chairman,
Joint Chiefs of Staff
Rose Gottemoeller, Director for Russia,
Ukraine and Eurasia Affairs, NSC Staff
(Notetaker)
Dmitry Zarechnak, Interpreter

Russia

Boris Yeltsin, President of the Russian
Federation
Viktor Chernomyrdin, Prime Minister
Andrei Kozyrev, Foreign Minister
Yuri Baturin, Secretary of National Security
Georgiy Mamedov, Deputy Foreign Minister
General Pavel Grachev, Defense Minister
Dmitriy Ryurikov, President's National
Security Advisor

Ukraine

Leonid Kravchuk, President of Ukraine
Yukhym Zwigilskiy, Acting Prime Minister
Anatoliy Zlenko, Foreign Minister
General Vitaliy Radetsky, Defense Minister
Anton Buteyko, President's National Security
Advisor
Yevhen Marchuk, Security Minister
Valeriy Shmarov, Deputy Prime Minister

DATE, TIME January 14, 1994, 8:35 - 8:55 a.m.
AND PLACE: St. Catherine's Hall, The Kremlin

DECLASSIFICATION AUTHORITY: Geoffrey W. Chapman, Senior Reviewer,
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President Yeltsin: Respected colleagues, we must put to rest one of the last problems of the Cold War. With this agreement, we will cement the global regime of nonproliferation, give impulse to radical reductions and remove the remaining barrier to disarmament. Our signature on the documents has legal, political and moral power. Each of us is writing a letter to our colleagues, making a package of documents with the Trilateral Statement and Annex. The letters are part of the package. They represent a balance of interests for the national security of all parties. We each entertained compromises and did not surrender positions of principle. We are giving Ukraine the opportunity to start in practice to implement independence while maintaining a policy of denuclearization. Its nuclear weapons are to be withdrawn within 28 & 1/2 months beginning on January 14 for their subsequent dismantling -- a minimum of 200 in the first 10 months. This is a very important beginning to a process. Russia and the U.S. will give full guarantees of security, as a sign of friendship and good neighborliness -- safely cementing it. (C)

Russia will give just compensation for strategic nuclear weapons and negotiations to agree on amount of compensation for the highly enriched uranium (HEU) in tactical nuclear weapons that were withdrawn from Ukraine. This must be done in a way that corresponds with the Massandra accords. We will do everything necessary to maintain ecological safety and will take into account costs to Russia for storage and transport of weapons. The United States will also extend substantial assistance. And the United States and Russia will have the possibility to proceed to ratify and implement START II. We are already ready to begin discussing further reductions with the United States, and further measures to enhance strategic stability, like the detargeting initiative we will announce today. (C)

I would like to underline the constructive role of Bill Clinton in developing and building a formula for agreement. I also applaud the willingness of the United States to work with Belarus and Kazakhstan as well as Ukraine on peaceful uses of nuclear material. (U)

[Yeltsin offers floor to the President; the President turns to President Kravchuk.]

President Kravchuk: I am sure we will sign the documents today because they are ready to sign, are they not? We have taken an enormous step in the elimination of nuclear weapons. Our agreements make this possible. They are a sign of mutual understanding of the problems of Ukraine and the good will to work on them. We again confirm that there is no alternative to nuclear disarmament. We will take the stable path. We will do everything possible so that the trilateral process works. From our side, the state of Ukraine will strictly adhere to the agreement. We are sure this will happen. I thank the United States and Russia for understanding the problems of Ukraine and for your readiness to assist us. (C)

President Yeltsin: Bill? (U)

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The President: Thank you very much. I want to commend you both on your wisdom and vision. I am very glad to have had the opportunity to be personally involved, as I know the Vice President is. I will continue to be personally involved. We must work to the end to keep our commitments. I am glad to hear you both say you feel the same way. I believe this agreement makes the world safer and each of our countries more secure. I am especially pleased to see the development of progress between Ukraine and Russia. As both President Yeltsin and President Kravchuk said to me separately, it is in Russia's interest for Ukraine to be stable and strong and it is in Ukraine's interest for Russia to be stable. Both countries have much potential to offer. The United States will actively participate in developing partnership among us. (C)

I'd like to end by drawing your attention to this tie a friend gave me over Christmas. He said it's a good symbol of my presidency. It says "carpe diem" -- seize the day. And you have done exactly that. I am convinced that in times of change those who survive are those who seize the day. We have all said enough. I think we should go sign the agreements. (U)

President Yeltsin: Thank you -- but we have to do the exchange of letters first. As I understand I pass this letter to President Clinton and I am expecting a letter from Leonid Makarovich. (C)

[All review letters.]

President Yeltsin: I am satisfied. Let's go into the adjacent hall for the signing. (U)

-- End of Conversation --

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